Sherwood Drone as First Responder Program

Documentary Timeline and Contract-Implementation Review

Prepared for: Members of the Sherwood City Council
Date: August 2026
Subject: BRINC/Motorola Drone as First Responder Program
Purpose: Documentary chronology of evaluation, contracting, technical integration, implementation, and public presentation

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Executive Summary

Records obtained concerning the Sherwood Police Department's BRINC Drone as First Responder ("DFR") program establish that substantial planning, policy development, contracting, technical integration, and implementation activity occurred before the program was publicly discussed at the July 27, 2026 Sherwood City Council meeting.

The presently available documentary record identifies the following sequence:

- A BRINC/Motorola proposal existed by **December 4, 2025**.
- Sherwood Police drafted detailed constitutional and operational restrictions for an expanding drone program on **January 12, 2026**.
- Additional BRINC/Motorola proposals were generated on **January 28 and January 29, 2026**.
- An agreement identified in City records as the executed BRINC/Motorola agreement was signed on **March 16, 2026**.
- By **April 16, 2026**, technical planning was underway to feed Sherwood CAD call information into BRINC LiveOps, with an anticipated **July/August 2026 go-live**.
- On **May 7, 2026**, Sherwood signed a separate **$1,250 Southern Software proposal for a "CAD CIM Interface – Brinc Drones."**
- The Police Department's own BRINC talking paper describes Southern Software CAD integration, Flock integration capability, WatchGuard Evidence Library integration, autonomous-launch options, LiveOps functionality, and Sherwood as already being established with a BRINC installation.
- The DFR program was publicly discussed before the City Council on **July 27, 2026**.
- By **August 20, 2026**, SPD had prepared a six-page interdepartmental MOU establishing a framework for Sherwood Fire Department personnel to operate the BRINC Responder under SPD administrative and FAA authority.

These records do not, standing alone, establish that any City official intentionally provided inaccurate information to the City Council. They do, however, demonstrate that the program had progressed through multiple identifiable implementation stages before the July 27 public discussion.

The principal governance question is therefore not whether Sherwood was merely considering drone technology in July 2026. The documentary record shows that consideration had begun substantially earlier.

The more precise questions are:

When did the City become contractually committed?

What authority supported that commitment?

When were members of the City Council informed of the agreement and implementation activities?

What was meant by describing the arrangement as a "free trial" or first-year evaluation after a contract had already been executed and City resources were being committed to implementation?

I. Scope and Methodology

This paper is based on records produced by or associated with the City of Sherwood, Sherwood Police Department, Southern Software Systems, BRINC, Motorola Solutions, and related implementation materials.

The purpose is to establish a chronology and identify issues appropriate for City Council review.

This document does **not** determine:

- whether any contract was legally valid or invalid;
- whether a particular City official possessed or lacked contracting authority;
- whether City Council approval was legally required;
- whether any public statement constituted intentional misrepresentation;
- whether any procurement law, municipal ordinance, or constitutional provision was violated.

Those questions require review by the City Attorney or other qualified counsel using the complete municipal record.

The distinction throughout this paper is between:

1. **Documented fact** — directly supported by a record;
2. **Reasonable inference** — a conclusion suggested by multiple records but not independently established; and
3. **Unresolved question** — an issue for which additional City records are necessary.

II. Documentary Timeline

December 4, 2025 — Initial BRINC/Motorola Proposal Identified

The City's subsequent records-production history identifies a **December 4, 2025 BRINC/Motorola quote or proposal** as the earliest presently identified formal proposal in the DFR procurement sequence. The same record identifies later January 28 and January 29 revisions or alternatives.

Significance

The project was therefore under formal vendor consideration no later than December 2025.

Additional communications preceding December 4 may exist. A current FOIA request seeks records back to January 1, 2025 specifically to identify earlier vendor contacts, demonstrations, meetings, pricing discussions, or internal deliberations.

III. January 12, 2026 — Operational and Constitutional Policy Development

On January 12, 2026, Officer Christopher Perez, identified as SPD's sUAS Team Commander, submitted an addendum concerning operational limits for drone use over residential, commercial, and apartment properties.

The memorandum states that the Sherwood Police Department's **"sUAS program expands"** and identifies the privacy implications of elevated non-public vantage points, hovering, zoom optics, and thermal sensors. It states that these capabilities create heightened constitutional scrutiny beyond normal patrol operations.

The memorandum further prohibits generalized proactive drone scanning of residential neighborhoods and expressly recognizes that residential curtilage receives strong Fourth Amendment protection and that drone surveillance may constitute a search.

The document establishes detailed operational rules involving:

- calls for service;
- active incidents;
- suspect searches;
- exigent circumstances;
- warrants;
- consent;
- residential surveillance;
- commercial surveillance;
- apartment-complex surveillance;

- directed patrol assignments;
- geographic boundaries;
- predetermined operational periods; and
- operator documentation.

Directed-patrol missions were to involve crime analysis, defined geographic boundaries, predetermined timeframes, and specific mission objectives.

The memorandum states that its provisions were intended for incorporation into annual sUAS operator training.

Significance

By January 12, SPD personnel were not simply evaluating the physical capabilities of a drone.

They were developing an operational governance framework addressing constitutional limits, liability, surveillance boundaries, training, and recurring deployment.

That indicates a level of program planning substantially beyond an informal demonstration.

Unresolved Issue

The available memorandum does not establish whether the January 12 addendum was formally approved by the Chief of Police or incorporated into Policy 13.13.00.

Council may wish to obtain the approval history and every version of the underlying sUAS policy.

IV. January 28–29, 2026 — Additional Vendor Proposals

City records identify additional BRINC/Motorola proposals dated **January 28 and January 29, 2026**. The pending records request specifically seeks communications explaining changes among the December and January versions, including pricing, equipment, services, contract duration, and program configuration.

Significance

Multiple proposals over a relatively short period indicate an active procurement and configuration process rather than receipt of a single unsolicited demonstration.

V. March 16, 2026 — Executed Agreement

City records subsequently identify an **executed March 16, 2026 BRINC/Motorola agreement**.

A current FOIA request specifically seeks communications concerning:

- review and approval of that agreement;
- who possessed authority to execute it;
- whether City Council approval was required;
- who received or reviewed the agreement;
- purchasing and procurement procedures;
- funding sources;
- purchase orders;
- invoices;
- payment authorization; and
- budget transfers.

Significance

March 16 is a critical point in the chronology.

After this date, the question is no longer solely whether Sherwood was **considering** a BRINC DFR program.

An agreement identified by the City's own records as executed was in existence.

That distinction should be central to Council review.

Questions for Council

1. Who signed the March 16 agreement on behalf of Sherwood?

2. Under what statutory, ordinance, budgetary, or delegated authority was it signed?

3. Was the City Council provided a copy before execution?

4. Was the City Council provided a copy after execution but before July 27?

5. What financial obligations arose immediately upon execution?

6. What financial obligations arose only upon "Go Live"?

7. What termination rights existed during the first operational year?

8. Would termination eliminate all City expenses, or only future BRINC contractual payments?

VI. Program Description — "Free" First Year and Contract Structure

SPD's internal BRINC talking paper provides important context for the terminology surrounding the first year.

It describes approximately:

- **$65,700 annually** for a three-year contract structure; and
- approximately **$85,000 annually** for a five-year structure.

The document characterizes the first year as **"no cost/free."**

More importantly, it explains why that first year exists:

> the first no-cost year is provided to Motorola customers to assist in obtaining a federal grant or **City Council approval for budget**.

The same document says the contractual "clock" begins at **Go Live**, rather than when the agreement is signed, and estimates approximately four months to reach that point.

It further states that the customer may cancel within the first 12 months with 30 days' notice and "no cost incurred."

Significance

This record provides important context that should accompany use of the phrase **"free trial."**

The available documentation appears to describe a structured vendor program in which:

1. an agreement is signed;
2. implementation begins;
3. the system proceeds toward Go Live;
4. a first-year no-cost period is provided;
5. that period may be used to seek grant funding or City Council budget approval; and
6. the customer possesses a first-year cancellation option.

That arrangement may reasonably be characterized as an evaluation or no-cost first year.

However, it is materially different from the ordinary understanding of a vendor temporarily loaning equipment to a City before the City enters into a contract.

The distinction should be explained clearly to the Council.

VII. April 16, 2026 — CAD and LiveOps Technical Integration Planning

An April 16 technical-integration questionnaire documents Sherwood's intended BRINC architecture.

Sherwood identified Southern Software as its CAD environment and reported support for web services, SFTP, JSON, SQL, and XML integration methods.

More importantly, Sherwood identified the information to be sent **into BRINC LiveOps**:

- latitude/longitude for calls for service;
- call type;
- incident number; and
- date/time.

The stated purpose of the integration was:

"Real-Time Ops, Evidence Library."

The anticipated Go-Live period was:

July/August 2026.

The questionnaire also identified Sherwood's surrounding technology environment:

- Flock — ALPR;
- Motorola Solutions/WatchGuard — Evidence Library;
- Motorola Solutions — radio;
- AT&T — cellular;
- Rave911 — Live911; and
- Southern Software — RMS.

Significance

By April 16, technical implementation planning had advanced to the point of identifying:

- data fields;
- data-transfer mechanisms;
- evidence systems;
- real-time operations;
- technical contacts; and
- an expected operational go-live period.

This is strong evidence that implementation activities were underway approximately three months before the July 27 Council discussion.

VIII. May 7, 2026 — Separate CAD Integration Purchase

A Southern Software proposal dated May 1 and signed by Sherwood on **May 7, 2026** provides a separate **$1,250 "CAD CIM Interface – Brinc Drones."**

The proposal states that 100% of the $1,250 amount was due upon signing.

Significance

This expenditure is particularly relevant to the characterization of the first year as "free."

Even if BRINC itself charged no first-year subscription fee, the documentary record establishes that Sherwood incurred—or contractually committed to incur—at least one separate implementation expense specifically associated with integrating BRINC into the City's CAD environment.

The distinction Council should examine is therefore:

"No first-year BRINC subscription cost"

versus

"No City cost associated with implementation."

Those are not necessarily the same proposition.

IX. The Internal Talking Paper Describes a Fully Integrated DFR Architecture

SPD's BRINC talking paper provides considerably more technical detail concerning the intended program.

It states that BRINC:

- integrates with Motorola WatchGuard Evidence Library;
- can support officer-duress launch functionality;
- integrates with Flock;
- can apply a rule allowing automatic launch on a warrant hit, stolen vehicle, or other event;
- integrates with Southern Software CAD;
- can use a rule for autonomous launch on priority calls;
- can allow an RPIC to make the launch decision;

- uses LiveOps for real-time viewing and control.

The talking paper specifically states regarding Flock:

> "Integrates with FLOCK and allows the option to delegate a 'rule' for drone to launch automatically on a warrant hit/stolen vehicle/etc or allow the RPIC to make the decision to launch."

It likewise describes Southern Software integration permitting autonomous launch rules for priority CAD calls and gives the integration cost as **$1,250 as of May 2026**.

The talking paper also states:

"Sherwood is currently being established with one being installed."

Important Limitation

The talking paper establishes that the proposed BRINC platform **has the capability** to integrate with Flock.

It does not, by itself, establish that Sherwood activated an automated Flock-triggered launch rule.

Council should distinguish carefully between:

- system capability;
- contracted capability;
- configured capability; and
- capability actually used operationally.

X. Infrastructure and Physical Implementation

The BRINC talking paper identifies the proposed launch location as either:

- the Sherwood Police Department; or
- Bill Harmon Recreation Center.

BRINC engineers were expected to determine the preferred location based upon facility availability and heat-map review.

The available record also describes installation as part of the vendor's overall package.

Other City records previously produced indicate that Sherwood incurred separate infrastructure expenses associated with preparing the Police Department roof for participation in the program.

Because the underlying invoices should be reviewed directly before assigning a final total, this paper does not state a definitive infrastructure expenditure.

Council should request a complete accounting of:

- roof modifications;
- mounting structures;
- electrical installation;
- network connections;
- internet service;
- antennas;
- conduit;
- power supplies;
- contractors;
- engineering;
- permits;
- CAD integration;
- software configuration;
- cellular service;
- training expenses; and
- staff time attributable to implementation.

The pending FOIA request seeks those categories specifically.

XI. July 27, 2026 — City Council Discussion

The official July 27, 2026 agenda confirms the regular Sherwood City Council meeting occurred at 6:00 p.m.

The agenda listed Flock under New Business but did not separately identify the BRINC DFR contract as an action item.

During the meeting discussion previously reviewed, the drone program was publicly described using language including a **"free trial"** and the City's ability to discontinue or "back out" after the first year.

For purposes of this paper, those statements should be evaluated against the documentary chronology rather than in isolation.

By July 27, the available records indicate that:

- drone policy work had existed since January;
- multiple vendor proposals had been evaluated;
- an agreement had been executed in March;
- technical CAD integration planning had occurred in April;
- a CAD integration had been purchased in May;
- LiveOps data fields had been identified;
- an anticipated July/August go-live had been established; and
- physical installation planning was underway.

Governance Issue

The central issue is not whether the first year could legitimately be described as free under BRINC's pricing model.

The internal talking paper itself uses "no cost/free."

The more important question is whether the public presentation gave the Council enough information to understand the **entire transaction and its stage of implementation**.

Council members should be able to determine whether they were informed that:

1. an agreement had already been executed;
2. implementation work had already occurred;
3. a separate CAD interface had already been purchased;
4. infrastructure expenses had been or would be incurred;
5. a go-live target had already been established;
6. the program was intended to integrate with existing public-safety systems; and
7. the no-cost first year was part of a structured Motorola/BRINC program intended, in part, to allow time for grant funding or Council budget approval.

XII. August 20, 2026 — Expansion to Fire Department Operations

On August 20, SPD prepared a six-page MOU governing Sherwood Fire Department operation of the BRINC Responder.

The MOU states that properly trained and FAA Part 107-certified Fire Department personnel could operate the BRINC Responder under SPD FAA authority, including applicable BVLOS authority.

SPD retained administrative oversight, regulatory responsibility, and operational priority.

The document also governs:

- operator qualifications;
- BRINC-specific training;
- system access;
- flight documentation;
- equipment security;
- software accounts;
- network components;
- user permissions;
- system integrations;

- cybersecurity;
- records management; and
- operational oversight.

The records provision specifically contemplates **imagery, video, telemetry, and other records maintained within an SPD-managed BRINC system.**

Significance

By August 20, SPD was preparing an interdepartmental governance structure for BRINC.

That is further evidence of institutional implementation rather than a limited equipment demonstration.

Important Qualification

The copy presently reviewed contains blank SPD and SFD signature blocks.

The MOU expressly states that it becomes effective only upon signature by both parties.

Accordingly, the document establishes that an MOU had been prepared, but this copy does **not** establish that the MOU became legally effective.

XIII. Consolidated Timeline

Date	Documentary Event	Program Significance
Dec. 4, 2025	Initial BRINC/Motorola proposal presently identified	Formal vendor evaluation/procurement underway
Jan. 12, 2026	Detailed sUAS constitutional and operational addendum	Policy and liability planning for expanding program
Jan. 28, 2026	Additional proposal	Contract/configuration development
Jan. 29, 2026	Additional proposal	Contract/configuration development
Mar. 16, 2026	Executed agreement identified in City records	Contractual stage reached
Apr. 16, 2026	CAD/LiveOps technical questionnaire	Real-time CAD integration and July/August go-live planned
May 7, 2026	$1,250 Southern Software BRINC CAD interface signed	City-funded technical integration

Date	Documentary Event	Program Significance
May–July 2026	Installation/integration activity	Physical and technical implementation
Jul. 27, 2026	Public City Council discussion	Council/public presentation occurs after substantial implementation activity
Jul./Aug. 2026	Targeted Go-Live period	Program intended to become operational
Aug. 20, 2026	SPD/SFD BRINC MOU prepared	Interdepartmental operational framework developed

XIV. Principal Findings

Finding 1 — The program predates the July Council presentation by months.

The documentary record places formal proposal activity in December 2025 and operational-policy development in January 2026.

The July meeting was therefore not the beginning of the City's evaluation process.

Finding 2 — A contract had been executed before the public presentation.

City records identify March 16, 2026 as the executed-agreement date.

The Council should determine when individual Council members were notified of that fact and what documentation they received.

Finding 3 — Technical implementation occurred before July 27.

By April, Sherwood was defining CAD information that would flow into BRINC LiveOps.

By May, the City had signed a separate $1,250 CAD-integration proposal.

The implementation questionnaire anticipated a July/August go-live.

Finding 4 — "Free trial" requires a more precise definition.

The City's own internal documentation supports the characterization of the first year as **"no cost/free."**

It also explains that the first year was part of a structured Motorola customer program intended to provide time to obtain federal grant funding or City Council budget approval.

Accordingly, the relevant Council question is not whether the phrase "free" appeared in internal documentation.

It did.

The question is **what was free, what was not free, what agreement had already been executed, and what implementation expenses the City had already incurred.**

Finding 5 — The system was being integrated into core public-safety infrastructure.

The records describe interaction with:

- CAD;
- LiveOps;
- Motorola WatchGuard Evidence Library;
- radio systems;
- Flock;
- incident information;
- GPS coordinates;
- software accounts;
- network components; and
- potentially automated launch rules.

This represents a public-safety technology architecture, rather than an isolated aircraft evaluation.

Finding 6 — The implementation record and Council-authorization record remain incomplete.

The presently reviewed documents do not conclusively establish:

- the first date every Council member learned about the program;
- whether Council approval was legally required;
- what authority was relied upon when the agreement was signed;
- the complete cost incurred during the first year;
- the exact amount spent on roof/infrastructure modifications;

- whether the Flock integration capability was activated;
- whether automated launch rules were configured;
- the exact BRINC Go-Live date;
- whether the August 20 SPD/SFD MOU was subsequently executed.

Those should remain identified as unresolved questions rather than assumptions.

XV. Questions Recommended for City Council Review

Contract Authority

1. Please provide the Council with the complete executed March 16, 2026 agreement and every incorporated term or attachment.

2. Who possessed authority to execute the agreement on behalf of Sherwood?

3. What ordinance, resolution, purchasing policy, budget authorization, or other delegation established that authority?

4. Did the City Attorney review the agreement before execution?

5. Was Council authorization required before execution, after execution, or only before future appropriations?

Council Knowledge

1. On what date was each Council member first informed that an agreement had been signed?

2. Were Council members provided the actual contract before July 27?

3. Were Council members informed of the December and January proposals?

4. Were they informed of the April technical integration work?

5. Were they informed of the May CAD-interface expenditure?

"Free Trial" Characterization

1. Precisely which BRINC products and services were free during the first year?

2. Which City expenses were excluded from the no-cost arrangement?

3. What infrastructure expenses had been incurred before July 27?

4. What happens financially if Sherwood cancels during the first year?

5. Does cancellation reimburse or eliminate third-party expenditures already made for infrastructure and integrations?

6. At what point does the City become responsible for the recurring annual contract amount?

7. What is the exact contractual definition of "Go Live"?

Technology Integration

1. Is Sherwood CAD currently feeding call-for-service information into BRINC LiveOps?

2. Is Motorola WatchGuard Evidence Library integrated with BRINC?

3. Is Flock currently integrated with BRINC?

4. Has Sherwood configured any rule allowing an ALPR alert, hotlist hit, warrant return, stolen-vehicle alert, CAD priority call, officer-duress event, or other automated trigger to launch the drone?

5. Who possesses authority to create or modify those rules?

6. Are configuration changes logged and auditable?

Privacy and Evidence

1. What is the retention period for BRINC imagery, video, telemetry, and LiveOps records?

2. Who can view live video?

3. Who can access historical video?

4. Are all accesses logged?

5. What policies govern incidental recording of residences, yards, windows, patios, balconies, and other constitutionally sensitive areas?

6. Was the January 12 sUAS addendum formally adopted?

7. What written policy currently governs DFR operations?

Program Status

1. What was the official Go-Live date?

2. When did operational testing begin?

3. When was the first public-safety mission flown?

4. Has SFD operated the BRINC Responder?

5. Was the August 20 MOU subsequently signed?

XVI. Recommended Council Action

The available record does not require the Council to reach an immediate conclusion regarding the value of the BRINC DFR technology.

It does support a need for a complete administrative review.

Before approving future appropriations or allowing the first-year period to convert into recurring contractual expenditures, the Council should consider requesting a single consolidated file containing:

1. every BRINC/Motorola quote and proposal;
2. the complete executed March 16 agreement;
3. all incorporated terms and conditions;
4. purchasing and legal-review records;
5. budget authorization;
6. all implementation invoices;
7. infrastructure expenditures;
8. the Southern Software CAD agreement;
9. all BRINC integration documentation;
10. the City's current FAA authorization;
11. current sUAS/DFR policy;
12. training documentation;
13. current LiveOps configuration;
14. active integrations;
15. configured automated-launch rules;
16. data-retention settings;
17. user-access and audit procedures;
18. the actual Go-Live date;
19. the executed SPD/SFD MOU, if one exists; and
20. a complete accounting of current and future financial obligations.

The Council can conduct this review without taking a position for or against police drone technology.

It is fundamentally a question of **contract administration, municipal authorization, financial oversight, technology governance, and the completeness of information provided to the governing body.**

XVII. Conclusion

The documentary timeline currently available does not depict a program that first emerged at the July 27, 2026 City Council meeting.

It depicts a progression:

Proposal → policy development → revised proposals → executed agreement → technical integration → City expenditure → implementation → public presentation → interdepartmental operational planning.

The term **"free trial"** may accurately describe an important component of BRINC's first-year pricing structure.

It does not, standing alone, adequately describe the entire administrative history demonstrated by the records.

By the time the program reached the City Council discussion on July 27:

- the project had been under consideration for months;
- detailed operational rules had been drafted;
- an agreement had been executed;
- technical integrations were being developed;
- City funds had been committed to CAD integration;
- a July/August operational target had been established; and
- the system was being designed to interact with Sherwood's broader public-safety technology environment.

The appropriate next step is therefore not to presume wrongdoing.

It is to establish the complete record.

The City Council should determine what was authorized, when it was authorized, who possessed the authority, what the City had already committed before July 27, what Council members knew at each stage, and what obligations will arise if the City allows the first-year period to transition into the recurring contract term.

Those answers would allow the Council and the public to evaluate the program on a complete factual record rather than isolated descriptions of individual stages of implementation.